

Zakiy T. Manigo

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I put models that already exist into products people use, with real limits on grounding, cost, latency, and what happens when the model is wrong. That last mile is the job: a proxy, a quota, a human in the loop, and a kill switch on the path the user sees. I completed a Columbia B.S. in Computer Engineering through the Combined Plan and I am based in New York / New Jersey.

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

BariAccess Livingston, NJ / Hybrid
Software Engineer June 2025 – Present

- Served as one of two primary engineers and productized ABA as a fail-closed Azure OpenAI assistant on TREI (trei.care), with voice and text sharing one policy path.
- Kept the backend as the authority and the model as a renderer, classifying urgent, clinical, and injection routes before generation.
- Stored keys in Key Vault and encoded rate limits, retention, and medical-claim output checks in code rather than in prompt text alone.
- Held ABA to approved clinical meaning on public and clinic surfaces through patient-language rules in the product.

City of Elizabeth Elizabeth, NJ
Database Engineer Intern May 2024 – September 2024

- Administered MongoDB and Excel document stores supporting a knowledge-sharing network used by more than 500 municipal staff.
- Automated reporting pipelines and improved data flow across departments so shared records could be reused without a manual handoff.

PROJECTS

FITD AI Remote
Founder and Engineer May 2024 – Present

- Put closet and brand labeling, a wardrobe-grounded stylist, and Vertex virtual try-on behind a Cloud Function proxy with keys on the server.
- Ran community bots with human approval, quotas, moderation, and a kill switch on Gemini, Imagen, and Veo so generation stays inside product gates.

Local AI Remote
Product Engineer August 2026 – Present

- Built an offline GGUF desktop client with documents and retrieval-augmented generation on llama.cpp so inference stays on the machine.
- Kept a fully offline default in which the UI runs local inference as a child process and stores chats in SQLite.

FitGenius Remote
Founding Technical Partner May 2026 – Present

- Applied Gemini on Vertex AI to fitness under a catalog-constrained coach so answers stay inside allowed context.
- Stripped GPS, health samples, and photos from model payloads before the request leaves the device path.

LaunchPage Studio Remote
Founding Engineer October 2025 – Present

- Shipped Automotive Operations System as a shop operations platform with role-based access and a delivery playbook so the next client can be stood up from the same path.
- Automated the financial loop the shop already closes using Stripe webhooks and scheduled Cloud Functions on Automotive Operations System.
- Built TaxTracker Pro as a records workspace with tax-year documents, exception reports, and export, with Stripe and store billing jobs behind signature verification.

EDUCATION

Columbia University New York, NY
Bachelor of Science in Computer Engineering May 2025

Fu Foundation Combined Plan 3+2

Computer Architecture, Databases, AI, Embedded Systems, and UI Design

St. Lawrence University Canton, NY
Bachelor of Arts in Mathematics May 2023

Dean's List, Spring 2022

Calculus, Linear Algebra, Differential Equations, and Group Theory

James Cook University Townsville, QLD, Australia
Undergraduate Exchange Fall 2022

Statistical Data Mining, Probability and Stochastic Processes, Game Design, and Human Rights

SKILLS/INTERESTS

Skills: Gemini, Vertex AI, Azure OpenAI, llama.cpp / GGUF, prompt packs, kill switches, grounding, TypeScript, Swift, React, Expo, Fastify, Firebase / GCP, Azure, Rust / Tauri

Interests: calisthenics, gym, running, basketball, golf, snowboarding, hiking, skeet, pop/R&B production, cooking, journaling, travel, poker

Community: Siloam-Hope First Presbyterian; NAACP Elizabeth Branch; Supervising Tutor, Central Presbyterian Church